

✓ Research Ethics - A. Project Details

A1. Title of research project /study

Violence reduction and access to higher education: post-conflict evidence from Colombia

A2. Is this study funded?

No

A3. Abstract

Your abstract should outline in non-technical language the purpose of the research (Approx. 150-200 words)

This study aims to examine how Colombia's violence reduction affects higher education access. In 2016, the national government and the FARC guerrillas signed a peace agreement. The implementation of this accord led to a decrease in violence nationwide, particularly in municipalities where the guerrilla group had a stronger presence. Recent evidence has shown that the reduction in violence increases school retention and improves academic performance for primary and secondary students in these areas. However, there is a lack of information regarding the effects on higher education; therefore, this analysis focuses on filling this gap using a difference in differences method.

A4. Data Collection

Briefly describe the data collection method(s) to be used (Approx. 100-150 words)

The study focuses on students who completed the Saber 11 standardized Colombian national exam between 2010 and 2024, representing the core demographic for potential higher education demand in the country. By utilizing anonymized longitudinal data publicly available through the Colombian Institute for the Evaluation of Education - ICFES web portal, this research establishes a direct link between secondary school exit exams and subsequent enrollment in technical, technological, and professional programs. This matching process allows for a precise identification of transition rates, enabling a clear determination of both the volume of students accessing higher education and the specific timing of their entry into the system.

Regarding violence information, the Historical Memory Centre in Colombia has all the data related to human rights violations committed within the armed conflict context. It is at the municipal level, from 1996 to 2024. It records the number of events and victims associated with targeted killings, terrorist attacks, kidnappings, sexual violence, massacres, enforced disappearances, antipersonnel mines, recruitment of children and adolescents, and other forms of violence. This information is aggregated at the municipal level.

A5. In what country or countries will data collection take place? Will you travel there, or will the research be conducted remotely/online?

Where research is to be conducted outside the UK, the researcher must establish whether local ethics review is required by the host country.

Colombia

A6. Will your study be conducted in the [LSE Behavioural Lab \(http://www.lse.ac.uk/management/research/brl/\)](http://www.lse.ac.uk/management/research/brl/)?

No

A7. When do you expect to begin data collection?

If you will be using secondary data only, please enter 'Not applicable'.

Not applicable

A8. What is the approximate duration of your data collection?

If you will be using secondary data only, please enter 'Not applicable'.

Not applicable

✓ Research Ethics - B. Researcher Details

B1. Your Name

JULIANA SOFIA ARAGON ACEVEDO

B2. Are you the lead researcher (at LSE) on the project?

If you are completing this form on behalf of someone else, please select 'no' (responses to questions B4 to B6 should then relate to the lead researcher).

MSc students: if you are, for example, completing this ethics review for your dissertation, then you are the lead researcher.

Where students are working together on a group project, only one student needs to complete the ethics review form. Please list other members of the group in the 'Co-researchers' section.

Yes

B3. If you are working with any co-researchers please list them (and their institution) here. Otherwise enter N/A

N/A

B4. Are you:

*Please select from the drop down list. **MSc**, **Exec MSc**, and **MPA** students should select 'PGT'.*

PGT

B5. Name of Programme (please start typing and select from the list):

MSc in Applied Social Data Science (/lightning/r/0015800001a55SuAAI/view).

B6. Name of Department/Centre/Institute (please start typing and select from the list).

If your unit is not listed, please contact research.systems@lse.ac.uk (<mailto:research.systems@lse.ac.uk>).

Methodology (/lightning/r/0015800000guoXcAAI/view).

B7. Name and email address of departmental ethics reviewer:

The person named here must not be someone involved in the research itself.

Students should enter the name/email address of their project/dissertation/thesis supervisor (or academic mentor/advisor) as appropriate. If your supervisor is involved in the research as a co-researcher/co-author then you must name an alternative reviewer here, such as a 2nd supervisor or the Departmental ethics approver (see link below for list).

(Please note that PhD students cannot approve ethics reviews, so please do not enter their details below).

Staff should enter the name/email address of the departmental ethics approver. A list of current departmental ethics approvers can be found [here](https://info.lse.ac.uk/staff/divisions/research-and-innovation/research/Assets/Documents/PDF/Departmental-ethics-approvers-web.pdf) (<https://info.lse.ac.uk/staff/divisions/research-and-innovation/research/Assets/Documents/PDF/Departmental-ethics-approvers-web.pdf>).

Eleanor Power

Email address of supervisor/approver (*this must be their LSE email address - please start typing and select from the list. If they are not listed please email research.systems@lse.ac.uk*):

e.a.power@lse.ac.uk (<mailto:e.a.power@lse.ac.uk>) (/lightning/r/00558000004ktcnAAA/view).

✓ Research Ethics - C. Review required

C1. Will your data collection – or any planned post-study engagement/impact activities - involve **ANY** of the following?

a) Interviews, surveys, focus groups, experiments, observations of people, etc., or any other type of user generated data (e.g. from discussion forums, social media platforms, vlogs or blogs, comments on posts or articles).

No

b) The collection of any personal data/identifiable information (e.g. names, email addresses, IP addresses, social media profiles or meta-data, visual material, etc.) or use of any secondary data that include any personal data/identifiable information. (*However, research that will **only** use data from publicly available archival records, including newspapers, does not require ethics review. In this case you may answer No here (unless there are other reasons why it may give rise to ethical issues.)*)

No

c) Any other information that could identify (or potentially lead to the identification of) a living individual. For example, where information from micro datasets, if combined, could lead to the identification of individuals or where an online search for particular wording could lead to the identification of an individual.

No

d) The potential that findings/conclusions/impact/publication may have damaging repercussions (reputation, stigma, bullying) for any individuals or groups with protected characteristics.

No

C2. Is there any other reason why your research might raise ethical issues, or why you need ethics approval?

No

C3. Will the research involve accessing security-sensitive material, such as material related to terrorism or violent extremism of any kind?

If Yes, you must complete a [DMP](https://www.lse.ac.uk/library/research-support/research-data-management-and-open-data) (<https://www.lse.ac.uk/library/research-support/research-data-management-and-open-data>) and submit that to the [data librarian](mailto:datalibrary@lse.ac.uk) (<mailto:datalibrary@lse.ac.uk>), for feedback so that they can advise on how to securely/safely access such materials. (The DMP can be completed/submitted either before or after submission of your ethics review form.)

No